Block practice · Social influence

Work through each question type in order. Each section has a worked-example retry and all further practice. Attempt only the part outlined in red.

The Stanford prison study (Haney, Banks and Zimbardo)

Why people obey - and how to stop blind obedience

Conformity to majority influence

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Practice workbook · The Stanford prison study (Haney, Banks and Zimbardo)

The Stanford prison simulation: sample, procedure, rules, clothing, findings and its use to explain uniform and role effects.

10 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 9 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-SOC-05

1. Question 26 · part whole · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part whole only.

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26 Casey is investigating the influence of wearing a uniform on participant behaviour.

She goes to a local business sales office where every staff member is wearing a smart suit. Casey asks the staff to make a phone call to a customer and records them.

Later that week, Casey asks the same staff members to come to the office wearing casual clothes. She asks them to make another phone call to a customer and records them.

Casey listens to both sets of recordings of the sales calls from the workers.

Explain what Casey is likely to find regarding the sales calls by the staff members when wearing smart suits and when wearing casual clothes.

You should refer to Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973) in your answer.

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(Total for Question 26 = 2 marks)

Working and answer

2. Question 19 · part a · 1 mark

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

19 Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973) conducted a study that has become commonly known as the 'Stanford Prison Experiment'.

(a) Identify the number of days that the study by Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973) ran for before being abandoned.

(1)

- ☒ **A** 5
- ☒ **B** 6
- ☒ **C** 7
- ☒ **D** 8

(b) State the number of people that responded to the newspaper advertisement in Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973).

(1)

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(Total for Question 19 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

3. Question 19 · part b · 1 mark

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

19 Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973) conducted a study that has become commonly known as the 'Stanford Prison Experiment'.

(a) Identify the number of days that the study by Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973) ran for before being abandoned.

(1)

- ☒ **A** 5
- ☒ **B** 6
- ☒ **C** 7
- ☒ **D** 8

(b) State the number of people that responded to the newspaper advertisement in Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973).

(1)

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(Total for Question 19 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

4. Question 18 · part a · 1 mark

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

18 As part of your course you will have studied Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973).

(a) Identify **one** of the rules included in Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973).

(1)

- ☒ **A** Two supervised toilet visits per day
- ☒ **B** Three visits per week
- ☒ **C** Lining up to be counted four times per day
- ☒ **D** Three meals per day

(b) Junbin is with his friends at the park. He and his friends all have face masks and dark clothing with hoods. Junbin and his friends act aggressively towards passers by in the park.

Junbin later goes to his local shopping centre with his friends. Signs inform them that CCTV cameras are in operation in the shopping centre. They choose not to wear their face masks and put their hoods down.

Explain why Junbin and his friends may be less likely to act aggressively at the shopping centre than at the park.

You should refer to Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973) in your answer.

(2)

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4. Question 18 · part a · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

5. Question 18 · part b · 2 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

18 As part of your course you will have studied Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973).

(a) Identify **one** of the rules included in Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973).

(1)

- ☒ **A** Two supervised toilet visits per day
- ☒ **B** Three visits per week
- ☒ **C** Lining up to be counted four times per day
- ☒ **D** Three meals per day

(b) Junbin is with his friends at the park. He and his friends all have face masks and dark clothing with hoods. Junbin and his friends act aggressively towards passers by in the park.

Junbin later goes to his local shopping centre with his friends. Signs inform them that CCTV cameras are in operation in the shopping centre. They choose not to wear their face masks and put their hoods down.

Explain why Junbin and his friends may be less likely to act aggressively at the shopping centre than at the park.

You should refer to Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973) in your answer.

(2)

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5. Question 18 · part b · 2 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

(c) Explain **two** weaknesses of using Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo's (1973) study as an explanation of the change in behaviour of Junbin and his friends at the shopping centre.

(4)

Weakness 1

Weakness 2

(Total for Question 18 = 7 marks)

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5. Question 18 · part b · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

6. Question 18 · part c · 4 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

18 As part of your course you will have studied Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973).

(a) Identify **one** of the rules included in Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973).

(1)

- ☒ **A** Two supervised toilet visits per day
- ☒ **B** Three visits per week
- ☒ **C** Lining up to be counted four times per day
- ☒ **D** Three meals per day

(b) Junbin is with his friends at the park. He and his friends all have face masks and dark clothing with hoods. Junbin and his friends act aggressively towards passers by in the park.

Junbin later goes to his local shopping centre with his friends. Signs inform them that CCTV cameras are in operation in the shopping centre. They choose not to wear their face masks and put their hoods down.

Explain why Junbin and his friends may be less likely to act aggressively at the shopping centre than at the park.

You should refer to Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973) in your answer.

(2)

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6. Question 18 · part c · 4 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

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(c) Explain **two** weaknesses of using Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo's (1973) study as an explanation of the change in behaviour of Junbin and his friends at the shopping centre.

(4)

Weakness 1

Weakness 2

(Total for Question 18 = 7 marks)

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6. Question 18 · part c · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

7. Question 22 · part a · 1 mark

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

22 As part of your course, you will have studied Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973).

(a) Identify the number of male participants selected from the 75 who responded to the newspaper advertisement in Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973).

(1)

☒ **A** 4

☒ **B** 14

☒ **C** 24

☒ **D** 34

(b) State how long the Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973) study was supposed to last for before being abandoned after 6 days.

(1)

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(Total for Question 22 = 2 marks)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

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Working and answer

8. Question 22 · part b · 1 mark

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

22 As part of your course, you will have studied Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973).

(a) Identify the number of male participants selected from the 75 who responded to the newspaper advertisement in Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973).

(1)

- ☒ **A** 4
- ☒ **B** 14
- ☒ **C** 24
- ☒ **D** 34

(b) State how long the Haney, Banks, and Zimbardo (1973) study was supposed to last for before being abandoned after 6 days.

(1)

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(Total for Question 22 = 2 marks)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

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Working and answer

9. Question 18 · part a · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

18 You will have studied Haney, Banks and Zimbardo (1973).

(a) State the **two** types of clothing that were worn by the participants in Haney, Banks and Zimbardo (1973).

(2)

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(b) Identify **two** of the rules that were included in Haney, Banks and Zimbardo (1973).

(2)

- ☒ **A** Four supervised toilet visits per day
- ☒ **B** Scheduled exercise and movie times
- ☒ **C** Two meals per day
- ☒ **D** Lining up to be counted three times per day
- ☒ **E** One visit per week

(Total for Question 18 = 4 marks)

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Working and answer

10. Question 18 · part b · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

18 You will have studied Haney, Banks and Zimbardo (1973).

(a) State the **two** types of clothing that were worn by the participants in Haney, Banks and Zimbardo (1973).

(2)

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(b) Identify **two** of the rules that were included in Haney, Banks and Zimbardo (1973).

(2)

- ☒ **A** Four supervised toilet visits per day
- ☒ **B** Scheduled exercise and movie times
- ☒ **C** Two meals per day
- ☒ **D** Lining up to be counted three times per day
- ☒ **E** One visit per week

(Total for Question 18 = 4 marks)

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Working and answer

Practice workbook · Why people obey - and how to stop blind obedience

Factors (personality and situation) that raise or lower obedience to a person in authority, and ways to stop blind obedience.

6 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 5 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-SOC-01

1. Question 21 · part whole · 4 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part whole only.

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21 A football team is in the final match of its season and is trying to win a trophy. The team is not as good as the other team it is playing.

The manager of the football team asks his players to kick and hurt the opposition players during the match. He tells them to shout insults at them and push them over in an effort to win the match.

Explain **two** ways to prevent blind obedience to the football manager.

You must use concepts or research evidence about obedience to justify your answer.

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(Total for Question 21 = 4 marks)

OLevels.com SCHOOL

1. Question 21 · part whole · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

2. Question 24 · part a · 4 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

24 Adam is interested in people's reactions to the influence of authority. He asks male and female participants to come to a room individually.

Half of the male and female participants are asked by a man dressed as a firefighter to lie down on the floor next to the window as there is 'a safety issue in the room'. The other half of the male and female participants are asked by a 'firefighter', who is not in the room, over a loudspeaker, to lie down on the floor next to the window as there is 'a safety issue in the room'.

(a) Explain **two** findings that Adam may discover regarding the participants' reaction to the 'firefighters'.

You should use research evidence about factors affecting obedience to justify your answer.

(4)

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2. Question 24 · part a · 4 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

(b) Explain **two** improvements that could be made to Adam's study.

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(Total for Question 24 = 8 marks)

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2. Question 24 · part a · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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3. Question 21 · part a · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

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21 Eniola was in assembly at school. She was talking with her friend and they were playing on their mobile phones whilst the head teacher was speaking.

A new teacher to the school signalled from across the hall to Eniola and her friend to stop talking and playing on their mobile phones. Eniola stopped talking and playing on her mobile phone, but her friend carried on talking and playing on her mobile phone.

(a) Explain how personality could account for Eniola following the teacher's instruction.

(2)

(b) Explain how the situation could account for Eniola's friend not following the teacher's instruction.

(2)

(Total for Question 21 = 4 marks)

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3. Question 21 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

4. Question 21 · part b · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

21 Eniola was in assembly at school. She was talking with her friend and they were playing on their mobile phones whilst the head teacher was speaking.

A new teacher to the school signalled from across the hall to Eniola and her friend to stop talking and playing on their mobile phones. Eniola stopped talking and playing on her mobile phone, but her friend carried on talking and playing on her mobile phone.

(a) Explain how personality could account for Eniola following the teacher's instruction.

(2)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

(b) Explain how the situation could account for Eniola's friend not following the teacher's instruction.

(2)

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(Total for Question 21 = 4 marks)

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4. Question 21 · part b · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

5. Question 23 · part a · 4 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

23 Hannah was investigating how obedient people would be to an authority figure.

She got permission from a train station to conduct her investigation during a busy rush hour period. Passengers were requested to only leave the train station via one of the exits by an authority figure.

Hannah compared the findings from three variations:

Variation A: the request was given in person or over a loudspeaker.

Variation B: the request was given by a man who wore a uniform or casual clothes.

Variation C: the request was given by a male or female authority figure.

Hannah's results are shown in **Table 5**.

	Variation A: Authority figure presence		Variation B: Clothes worn by authority figure		Variation C: Gender of authority figure	
	In person	Loudspeaker	Uniform	Casual	Male	Female
% obedience	30	10	45	15	30	30

Table 5

(a) Explain **two** conclusions that could be made in terms of obedience to authority using the data in **Table 5**.

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5. Question 23 · part a · 4 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of Hannah's investigation.

(4)

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(Total for Question 23 = 8 marks)

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5. Question 23 · part a · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

6. Question 23 · part whole · 4 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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23 A high-ranking soldier in the army is ordering the soldiers in his command to harm innocent villagers.

He is telling the soldiers to go to the houses in the village, remove people from their houses and take them to a central unit where they are being hurt.

The people in the houses are all innocent of any crime.

Explain **two** ways that blind obedience to the high-ranking soldier could be prevented.

You should use concepts or research evidence about obedience to authority to justify your answer.

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(Total for Question 23 = 4 marks)

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6. Question 23 · part whole · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

Practice workbook · Conformity to majority influence

The meaning of conformity and how personality and situational factors change conformity to a majority.

6 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 5 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-SOC-02

1. Question 19 · part whole · 4 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part whole only.

19 Callum wanted to investigate conformity to majority influence in his students.

He gave his students two quizzes. One was an easy general knowledge quiz and the other was a hard general knowledge quiz.

To test for conformity, Callum used two classes of students:

- Class one: 85% of the students were confederates / stooges, who were told by Callum to give the same wrong answer to all the questions in the two quizzes.
- Class two: 55% of the students were confederates / stooges, who were told to give the same wrong answer to most of the questions in the two quizzes, but sometimes a different wrong answer.

Callum recorded the number of times the other students in the two classes gave the same wrong answer as the confederates / stooges.

Callum's findings are shown in **Table 3**.

Class	Average percentage (%) of the other students who gave the same wrong answer as the confederates / stooges for the easy quiz	Average percentage (%) of the other students who gave the same wrong answer as the confederates / stooges for the hard quiz
Class one **85% confederates / stooges, always gave same wrong answer**	15%	50%
Class two **55% confederates / stooges, mostly gave same wrong answer**	5%	30%

Table 3

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1. Question 19 · part whole · 4 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part whole only.

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Explain **two** conclusions that could be made from the data in **Table 3** in terms of conformity to majority influence.

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(Total for Question 19 = 4 marks)

1. Question 19 · part whole · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

2. Question 22 · part whole · 2 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

22 Leonora goes to the cinema to watch a film with her friends. She wants to watch a film about unicorns taking over the world, whereas her friends all want to watch a film about car racing.

Leonora goes to watch the film about car racing.

Explain why Leonora went to see the film about car racing.

You should refer to a factor affecting conformity to majority influence in your answer.

(Total for Question 22 = 2 marks)

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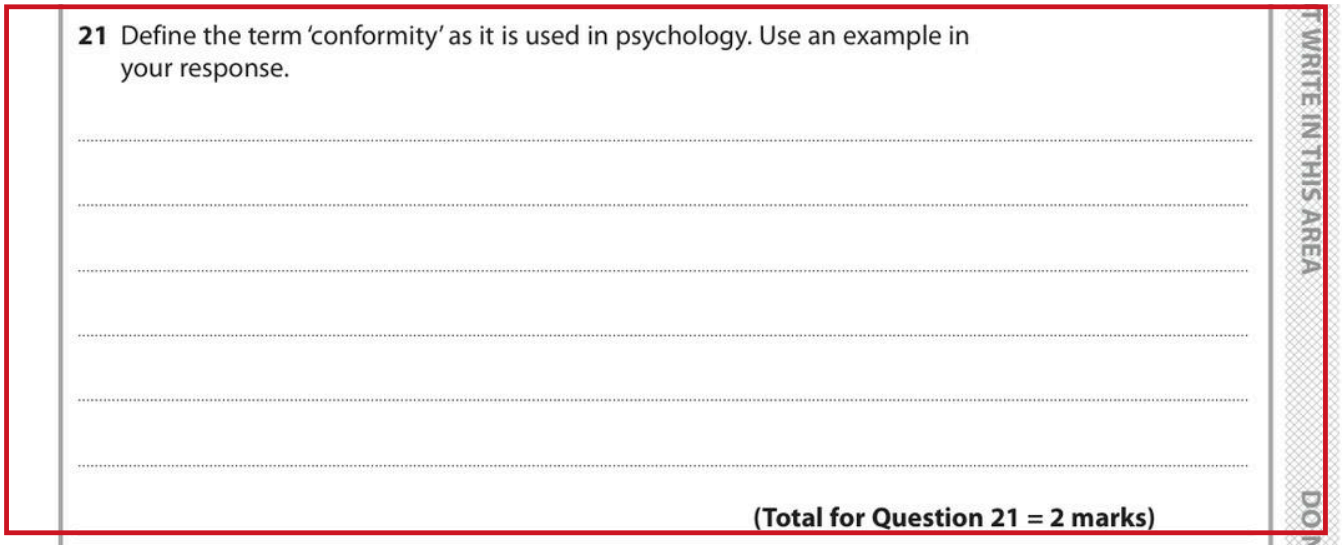
OLevels.com SCHOOL

Working and answer

3. Question 21 · part whole · 2 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



21 Define the term 'conformity' as it is used in psychology. Use an example in your response.

(Total for Question 21 = 2 marks)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL

4. Question 22 · part whole · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

22 Describe the difference between 'obedience' and 'conformity'.

(Total for Question 22 = 2 marks)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

Working and answer

OLevels.COM SCHOOL

5. Question 25 · part whole · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

25 Sergio and his five friends go to their favourite local French restaurant. Sergio orders snails for everyone to eat whilst at the restaurant. All of his friends eat the snails, except his friend Leonard who does not eat one of the snails despite being encouraged by the rest of the group.

Explain **one** possible reason for the friends eating the snails and Leonard not eating the snails.

You should refer to how personality affects conformity to majority influence in your answer.

(Total for Question 25 = 2 marks)

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OLevels.COM SCHOOL

Working and answer

6. Question 20 · part a · 4 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

20 Ada wanted to see how the presence of others could influence exercise behaviour. She went to her local gym and recruited four volunteers to take part in her study as confederates / stooges.

Ada asked the confederates / stooges to run on the majority of the five running machines in the gym during the busy two-hour period, both in the morning and afternoon sessions. The fifth running machine was always left vacant.

Ada recorded, in minutes, how long the fifth running machine was used for in the morning and afternoon sessions, over a three-day period.

Ada's findings are shown in **Table 3**.

	Average time (mins) the fifth running machine was used in the morning session		Average time (mins) the fifth running machine was used in the afternoon session	
	No confederates / stooges	With confederates / stooges	No confederates / stooges	With confederates / stooges
Monday	100	118	113	115
Tuesday	98	110	112	110
Wednesday	97	112	96	95

Table 3

OLevels.com SCHOOL

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6. Question 20 · part a · 4 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

(a) Explain **two** conclusions that could be made from the data in **Table 3** in terms of conformity to majority influence.

(4)

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OLevels.com SCHOOL

6. Question 20 · part a · 4 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of Ada's study.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

(Total for Question 20 = 8 marks)

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OLevels.COM SCHOOL

6. Question 20 · part a · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

OLevels.com SCHOOL